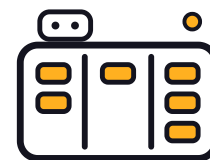


FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key



Robots Do the Boring Work — the sort key for all twelve tasks, a key or exemplar for every student item (trade cards, the claim, the listener strip, the exit ticket), discussion moves, the Defense Rubric, what to do when it goes sideways, and full standards text.

WHY THIS LESSON

Students hear "AI is taking the jobs" everywhere, usually as a scare. This lesson swaps the fear for a decision-making frame: **let the robots do the boring work; leave the humans to do the human things.** A good AI job runs **human → AI → human**: a person decides what the AI takes on, the AI does the middle, and a person checks the result and owns the decision. The honest middle-school version, hedged on purpose: AI takes over tasks, not whole jobs — nobody can promise the final count — and every automation choice carries a tradeoff (CSTA 2-IC-20). Student pages say "the trade." Stands alone — nothing here depends on another lesson.

SUGGESTED SORTS — READ THIS FIRST

Honest note: most tasks are defensibly AUGMENT. The column matters far less than the defense — a pair that puts D in KEEP HUMAN and names a real tradeoff beats a pair that matches this table with no reason. Grade the trade, not the column. "Two per column" is satisfiable from this key, including the Support set (skip B, F, J, L).

TASK	LIKELY COLUMN	THE TRADEOFF WORTH SURFACING
A — Session reminder texts	Automate	Wins hours back; a chirpy text after a cancellation stings.
B — Rename + back up files	Automate	Nobody misses it; the risk is silent failure — spot-check.
C — First-draft social captions	Augment	AI drafts fast, but the studio's voice is Jaylen's.
D — Rough first mix of a new song	Augment	AI gets most of the way; Ravi's ears decide what ships.
E — Coach a nervous first-time singer	Keep human	Confidence is the point; a chatbot coach costs the singer.
F — Payment reminders	Automate	A job nobody wants; a loyal regular gets a cold nudge.
G — Pick the song to release first	Keep human / Augment	Taste is Nia's edge; AI can report trends, not decide.
H — Microphones + echo for a live band	Keep human / Augment	Craft plus judgment; AI can suggest, hands do the work.
I — Agree on a price	Keep human	Trust and reading the room; a bot can cost the booking.
J — Type up the rap lyrics	Automate	Transcription; it can mishear a line — the artist checks.
K — The same five email questions	Automate	Same answers daily; the risk is the sixth question.
L — Song order + mood for show night	Keep human / Augment	The mood is live connection; AI can draft the checklist.

ANSWER KEY — WORKSHEET P.2 (TRADE CARDS, DEFEND IT, EXIT TICKET)

ITEM	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
Trade Cards (the DOK-3 item — two per student)	Worked exemplar, Task K in AUTOMATE. <i>Who wins?</i> Jaylen — the same five answers go out instantly and he gets his mornings back. <i>Who loses something?</i> The person with the sixth question, the one the bot can't answer — and Jaylen loses the small hello that used to start a relationship. <i>What could go wrong?</i> The bot says "yes, we have parking" the week the lot is closed. Score: a specific winner AND a specific loss plus one realistic failure = proficient; "it's faster" with no loss named = developing; "because robots" = redo. Any column is acceptable if the trade is real.
Defend It — the claim frame	Exemplar: "Task E belongs in KEEP HUMAN because a nervous first-time singer needs a person who can see she's shaking — and the trade is Nia spends an hour she could have spent booking the studio." A proficient claim has all four slots filled and the trade names a cost, not a repeat of the reason. Weak: "Task E belongs in KEEP HUMAN because it's human — and the trade is nothing."
Listener strip (eyes / voice / pace + keep / fix)	<i>Eyes</i> = the Speaker looked at the Listeners for most of the 30 seconds, not the page. <i>Voice</i> = the Listeners heard every word without leaning in. <i>Pace</i> = the Speaker slowed or paused on "because" and "the trade is." A good <i>keep</i> names a specific thing ("you said who lost something"); a good <i>fix</i> names a specific move ("look up on the trade"). The strip is peer evidence for SL.6.4 — each student's claim is scored by their Listener; your Defense Rubric samples confirm it. Unchecked boxes are honest data, not a punishment.
Exit Ticket — a real job	Exemplar: <i>The job:</i> my uncle's food truck. <i>Automate:</i> posting the truck's daily location — and who loses something: my uncle, a little; the regulars who used to text "where you at?" now just check the post, and that was half his hellos. <i>Augment:</i> planning how much food to buy each week — AI predicts, he decides. <i>Keep human:</i> joking with the regulars at the window, because that's why they come back. Score: proficient = a real task from that job in every column + a real loss on the AUTOMATE line + a why on KEEP HUMAN; developing = columns filled but no loss named; redo = "AI should do everything."

DISCUSSION MOVES (FOR THE HARD QUESTIONS)

Q: "Will AI take my mom's job?" — Stay honest, no predictions: "Some parts of almost every job get automated — usually the repeating parts. AI takes over tasks, not whole jobs — and nobody can promise the final count. The real question: which parts are the human parts? That's your exit ticket."

Q: The class splits three ways on one task — who's right? — Nobody, and say so. Push with: "Convince me. Who wins? Who loses something? What breaks?" A three-way split is the best Defend It material.

Q: "Isn't automating a task mean to whoever did it?" — Sit in that tension; it IS the standard. Jaylen, who loses the boring texts, also loses a way to learn every artist's name. Naming both sides out loud is the skill.

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

A pair puts ten letters in AUTOMATE → "Which two would you hate to lose a person on?" The rule (two per column) does the rest; make them defend the two.

"Nobody loses" on a trade card → Hand them the model: even Jaylen lost something. "Who used to do this task? What did they get from it?"

A Speaker reads to the desk → Don't score it. "Eyes on us, one more time." The second try counts — and tell the Listeners to check the second try. **Odd number of pairs** → one trio of pairs rotates; sample that group. Trio: 20 seconds each, listeners mark the boxes only.

A student is upset — a parent's job is on the board → Don't predict. "Some parts of that job may change; the parts that need a person are the parts your parent is good at. Which parts are those?" Then move the class on; follow up privately if needed.

DEFENSE RUBRIC — DEFEND THE BOARD (SL.6.4)

- **Proficient:** one clear claim, a specific detail from the task, names who wins AND who loses something or what breaks; eyes up, audible at the back wall — the listener strip shows three checks.
- **Developing:** claim plus a reason, but the trade is missing or vague ("it's just faster"); one or two checks.
- **Beginning:** restates the column with no because, or reads to the desk.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CSTA 2-IC-20** — Compare tradeoffs associated with computing technologies that affect people's everyday activities and career options. *Taught: Direct Instruction, the tradeoff lens modeled on the reminder texts. Assessed: Trade Cards (worksheet p.2 — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong) and the Exit Ticket AUTOMATE line, which names who loses something when a real job's task is automated.*
- **CCSS ELA SL.6.4** — Present claims and findings, sequencing ideas logically and using pertinent descriptions, facts, and details to accentuate main ideas or themes; use appropriate eye contact, adequate volume, and clear pronunciation. *Taught: the three delivery moves and the claim frame in the Defend It setup. Assessed: Defend It — each student's claim is scored on the listener strip (eyes / voice / pace + keep / fix) by their Listener, 30 seconds each; you sample 3–4 pairs with the Defense Rubric.*
- **ISTE 1.3.d** — Students build knowledge by actively exploring real-world issues and problems, developing ideas and theories and pursuing answers and solutions. *Taught: The Studio Task Board sort (real tasks, real business). Assessed: the Exit Ticket, applying the three columns to a real job in the student's life.*

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